About the Langtangen Prize

October 15, 2025

The Langtangen Prize will be awarded to the best paper (or papers) published in a given calendar year on the foundations of numerical simulation technology. The award is supported by the Ridgway Scott Foundation and the prize will be three thousand U.S. dollars per year.

The Langtangen Prize is named for Hans-Petter Langtangen (1962-2016). Hans-Petter epitomized the goals of the Ridgway Scott Foundation. His undergraduate training was in mathematics at the University of Oslo with a specialization in Mechanics. He was one of the developers of Diffpack. He joined the Department of Mathematics at the University of Oslo in 1991, later moving to a professorship in Computer Science in 1999 and joining Simula Research Laboratory at its foundation in 2001. He was a member of the European Academy of Sciences and the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters. His research in the foundations of numerical simulation always maintained close relevance to important applications, especially in biomedicine and geoscience. He was an ardent supporter of the FEniCS Project since its inception. He was also a wonderful teacher, author, and beloved mentor to several generations of scholars.

The Langtangen prize committee consists of

- Ingeborg Gjerde (Norwegian Geotechnical Institute),
- Matthew Knepley (University of Buffalo),
- Patrick Farrell (University of Oxford),
- Sara Pollock (University of Florida).

Nominations for the prize may be sent by e-mail to Patrick Farrell (chair of the committee) at `patrick.farrell@maths.ox.ac.uk`. Prizes will be announced in the summer, starting in 2025. Nominations need only list the name of the paper, the authors, and where published. If the paper is not easily available online, a PDF copy would be appreciated. Self-nominations are welcome.

Nominations are due by 1 April of each calendar year for papers published in the previous year. arXiv papers will be considered as well as journal publications.

The Ridgway Scott Foundation was formed in 2023 to support research on the foundations of simulation technology at the intersection of mathematics, models of the physical world, and computer science. The Foundation presented its first prizes at the FEniCS24 meeting in Oslo. The Foundation also posts prizes for solving fundamental problems on its web site.

For further information about the Foundation, contact Ridgway Scott at `ridg@uchicago.edu`.